

small intestine

Narrow section of the digestive tract, about 20 ft long, between the stomach and cecum, where a part of digestion and food absorption occurs.

jejunum

Middle section of the small intestine between the duodenum and the ileum; the majority of nutrients are absorbed here.

ileum

Terminal part of the small intestine between the jejunum and cecum.

large intestine

Last wide section of the digestive tract, about 5 ft long, where the final stage of digestion and elimination of waste occurs; it includes the colon and the rectum.

transverse colon

Second segment of the colon (middle section of the large intestine). The right colon (the ascending colon plus half the transverse colon) mainly enables absorption of water.

descending colon
Third segment of the colon; it stores waste before it is eliminated.

ascending colon

First segment of the colon; it absorbs water from food residue before it is excreted.

cecum

Anterior part of the large intestine; it receives food particles from the ileum.

vermiform appendix

Tubular extension of the cecum; this appendage is occasionally the site of appendicitis, a severe inflammation.

rectum

Terminal section of the large intestine preceding the anus.

sigmoid colon

Fourth segment of the colon; it carries waste to the rectum.